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User Researcher (Ref: 24078)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 22nd November 2026

Reference number

490302

Salary

£42,914 - £53,081

The national salary is £42,914 - £46,182. London salary is £49,325 - £53,081. Your salary will be dependent on your base location

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

MOJ Grade SEO

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

2

Contents

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This is a Nationally based role

Job description

User Researcher

Location: National*

Interviews: expected week commencing 7th December

Grade: SEO

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary:** London: £49,325 - £53,081 National: £42,914 - £46,182

Working pattern: Full-time, Part-time Flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 2

Vacancy number: 24078

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found ON THIS MAP**

Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

We re recruiting for **User Researchers** here at Justice Digital Data and Science (JDDS) to be part of our warm and collaborative product teams.

This role aligns against User Researcher from the Government Digital and Data Framework

We re looking for User Researchers who want to make a difference by working on public services that really matter.

You ll be welcomed into a thriving user research community and into multidisciplinary teams, alongside designers, business analysts, product managers, data scientists, delivery managers and developers all working together to deliver world-class, user-centred services.

At JDDS, our research spans a wide range of services, from prisons and probation to legal aid and data. Depending on where you're based, you may have the opportunity to visit places such as prisons, courts and probation delivery units, meeting people in their own environments and learning about their experiences, needs and challenges.

We are currently experimenting with different delivery models, so some of the time you might find yourself embedded full time on a product team, and at other times you might be providing research support to teams that share similar problems. You may be working alongside other researchers, or as a single researcher in a team. We are therefore looking for researchers who have pragmatic, flexible ways of working.

To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital Data and Science please take a look at our and our Digital and Technology strategy 2025

Benefits:

You ll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97% through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King s birthday.

Flexible working arrangements including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work life balance.

Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer here**.** To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science please look at our blog.

Key Responsibilities:

Plan, conduct, analyse and communicate research

Ensure the inclusion of different types of users in research activities

Effectively communicate research findings within project teams, and share findings with other relevant stakeholders

Work closely with product managers, designers, developers, data scientists and engineers to turn user research findings into actions that lead to valuable product and service designs

Contribute to building our user research and user centred design community, by developing our practice and ways of working.

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

Experience using research methods, primarily qualitative but ideally with some quantitative experience, and being able to select the right research method for the problem that needs to be solved

Ability being an advocate for users, encouraging teams to engage with research insights to help them make evidence-based decisions.

Experience ensuring research and insights support the iterative development of a service/product

- Experience including different kinds of users in appropriate research activities, and knowing how to run inclusive and ethical research
- Ability to build effective working relationships with a team and stakeholders
- Experience managing personal data, including following security and consent processes

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for BPSS clearance

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from London: £49,325 - £53,081 National: £42,914 - £46,182

- **New entrants to the Civil Service** joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.
- **Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer** will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.
- **Existing Civil Servants who are promoted** will either move to the bottom of the new grade s pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Terms & Conditions

Please review our Terms and Conditions which set out how we recruit and provide further information related to the role and salary arrangements.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact digitalanddatarecruitment@justice.gov.uk

Person specification

Please refer to the attached Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £42,914, Ministry of Justice contributes £12,432 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Access to learning and development
- A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance
- A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity
- A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%
- Annual Leave
- Public Holidays
- Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Government Digital and Data Profession Capability** and **Success Profiles** Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A Personal Statement (no more than 250 words per section) which should outline your experience and suitability against the following 3 criteria (750 words total). We recommend, clearly outlining each 3 sections and answers, in separate paragraphs within the statement.

- Experience using research methods, primarily qualitative but ideally with some quantitative experience, and being able to select the right research method for the problem that needs to be solved
- Experience ensuring research and insights support the iterative development of a service/product
- Experience including different kinds of users in appropriate research activities, and knowing how to run inclusive and ethical research

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

**Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on Experience using research methods, primarily qualitative but ideally with some quantitative experience, and being able to select the right research

method for the problem that needs to be solved will be conducted prior to the sift.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - Application Guidance

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a 1-hour panel interview held via video conference, which will include a user research task, given in advance of the interview.

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Government Digital and Data Profession Capability** and **Success Profiles** Frameworks. We will assess your Experience, Technical Skills and the following Behaviours during the assessment process:

- Communicating and influencing
- Working together

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in

the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/

https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?jobid=1285

Civil Service Commission

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